

Refining Paths Quick Reference

FDD 4.4 · DIGITAL
COMMUNICATIONS

NAME _____

DATE _____



Simplify

Object > Path > Simplify — reduces anchor points on a messy path while keeping its shape.



Join

Cmd/Ctrl+J — connects two selected open endpoints into one point, or closes an open path.



Shape Builder Tool

Shift+M — drag across overlapping shapes to merge them; Option/Alt-click a region to remove it.



Pathfinder — Unite

Combines all selected shapes into one single shape.



Pathfinder — Minus Front

Subtracts the top shape(s) from the shape behind them.



Offset Path

Object > Path > Offset Path — creates a new outline a set distance inside or outside a shape.

Two-Minute Drill (today's F3): when your teacher says go, take the low-poly facet you're working on and use **one** of the tools above to clean it up. Screenshot the before and after.